

Miss Martha Darrough

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Hq. & Hq. Det.

U.S. D.C. Supply

Ft. San Houston,

Tex.

Friday Morning 1⁰⁰⁰ A.M.
12-7-45

Dearest

It's very late and I'm very tired but I'm also desperately - passionately and hopelessly in love with you and I don't know when I'll get the opportunity again so I'll write you now while I'm in the mood.

It's quiet - everyone else is asleep - and I get to sleep in the morning so - I just got off evening duty and we really had a rugged evening. Some of these poor kids are really sick and need a lot of care - and since they don't get it at home - we give it here.

I've been thinking about you so much today - thinking about the things you said while you were home the last time - about the letters you wrote me and another big question mark comes to light in the back of my mind. Yet I think to myself - he must care something about me or he'd never have wanted to see me again or he'd never have written me three letters in a row without getting answers - but even that does

not blot out entirely the uncertainty
I feel.

I just finished writing two letters -
one to Bill and one to Ken - a sailor I
went to highschool with. He was president
of our senior class and student director
of the orchestra - Both of them think a
lot of me and regard neither one of
them more than just good pals and
nice guys to be with. Fate plays funny
tricks on us sometimes - I don't know
why things like that have to happen,
but they do. In the letters I wrote them
tonight - I told them that plans for
the future were out - because I just
didn't feel that way and in another
letter I pour out my heart to you
and I'm not sure that you even love
me or even will. But I'm yours Hop -
whenever you want me - You're the
only guy in the world that really
means anything to me and I want
you so badly that I feel helpless and
handcapped. I thought if I showed
you how much I loved you - you
too would soon feel that way about
me. I thought of our love as an intoxicating

disease that was contagious - that I
had enough germs to give you some,
too and then everything would be rosy.
But I see I looked at the world through
rose colored glasses - I thought everything
would be as I had planned it and in
that way I was very selfish. Maybe it
isn't right to be as happy as I had dreamed
it would be. at any rate I was terribly
disappointed - Because the light that
said "I love you" never fluctuated. It grew -
and brightened. September - October - were
very lonesome months for me - At that
time I have changed in some respects -
grew a little older - learned to face reality -
and learned to keep my chin up - but
my sentiments for you go on unchanged
except to intensify as Father time adds his
two bits to life. I've learned to take things
more in life's stride - not to expect too
much but never cease dreaming - and
right now I live in a world of imagination
where I choose my own subjects - dream
life as I want it - that makes up for
the vast emptiness that accompanies the
feeling of uncertainty.

But regardless of reality - I'm still
desperately - passionately and hopelessly
in love with you and that will continue
unchanged by the sands of time - distance
or interests -

It's Pearl Harbor Day today - just four
years ago we were faced with that
war - now supposedly it's all over and
~~people are settling down to normal~~
life again and we pray that it doesn't
happen again.

It's almost 1³⁰ now so I'd better close
but it's still

All my love with all my heart
All the remaining days of my
earthly existence - and
God bless you -
Martha